

EDUCATION	Columbia University M.A. in Media Studies & Sociology Advisors: Diane Vaughan, James Chu, David M. Markowitz Thesis: <i>Status Hierarchies in Language Models</i> Brigham Young University–Hawaii B.A. in Communication; Minor in Political Science Research Advisor: Mason Allred	2024 – 2025 2022 – 2024
AREAS OF INTEREST	AI Behavior; Science of Personas; Human-AI Interaction; Organizational Risk	
WORK EXPERIENCE	LASR Labs <i>Contractor</i> Supervised Program for Alignment Research <i>Research Mentor</i> Columbia AI Alignment Club <i>Research Manager / Fellowship Facilitator</i> Columbia Business School <i>Research Intern</i> Research Advisor: Alan Zhang Columbia University <i>Research Assistant</i> Research Advisor: James Chu	London, UK (<i>Remote</i>) Sept 2026 – Present Berkeley, CA (<i>Remote</i>) Dec 2025 – Present New York, NY Jan 2025 – Dec 2025 New York, NY June 2025 – Aug 2025 New York, NY Jan 2025 – July 2025
BOOK	[1] Outstanding Stories from Kiribati. Emilio Barkett <i>Barnes and Noble Press</i> , 2022. [link]	
PUBLICATIONS	[9] Normalization of Deviance in AI Development.† Emilio Barkett , Alexander Kimpton, Daniel Graham, Yusuf Kundgol <i>NeurIPS AI4Good Workshop</i> , 2026. [paper]. [8] Social Pressure Induces Moral Sycophancy in Frontier LLMs.† Roshni Lulla*, Kristin Witte*, Saloni Modi*, Emilio Barkett* <i>Working Paper</i> . [7] Whose Alignment? Process Alignment Across Organizational Contexts.† Niklas Weller*, Emilio Barkett* <i>ICML Workshop on Pluralistic Alignment</i> , 2026. [paper]. [6] Representation Without Control: Testing the Realization Effect in Language Models.† Ciaran Walsh, Emilio Barkett <i>arXiv preprint</i> , 2026. [paper]. [5] The Compulsory Imaginary: AGI and Corporate Authority. Emilio Barkett <i>arXiv preprint</i> , 2026. [paper] [4] Status Hierarchies in Language Models. Emilio Barkett <i>arXiv preprint</i> , 2026. [paper]. [3] Getting out of the Big-Muddy: Escalation of Commitment in LLMs. Emilio Barkett* , Olivia Long*, Paul Kröger <i>arXiv preprint</i> , 2025. [paper].	

[2] Don't Change My View: Ideological Bias Auditing in Large Language Models.

Paul Kröger, **Emilio Barkett**

arXiv preprint, 2025. [*paper*].

[1] Reasoning Isn't Enough: Examining Truth-Bias and Sycophancy in LLMs.

Emilio Barkett*, Olivia Long*, Madhavendra Thakur*

ICML Workshop on Models of Human Feedback for AI Alignment, 2025. [*paper*].

* Denotes equal contribution.

† Denotes projects mentored through SPAR.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

[5] Organizational Drift in Frontier AI Development: Evidence from Policy Revisions, Personnel Testimony, and National Strategies.†

Emilio Barkett, Alexander Kimpton, Daniel Graham, Yusuf Kundgol

Working Paper.

[4] Algorithmic Appreciation in Language Models.†

Maya De Ganyar, **Emilio Barkett**

Working Paper.

[3] Agent Swarm Dynamics.†

William Neild, **Emilio Barkett**

Working Paper.

[2] Deception in Language Models.†

Hannah Sun, **Emilio Barkett**

Working Paper.

[1] Economics of Token Output.†

Peiyu Chen, **Emilio Barkett**

Working Paper.

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

BlueDot Impact Rapid Grant, \$3,000.

Sept 2026

Supervised Program for Alignment Research, \$5,250.

Dec 2025 – Present

Claude Campus Ambassador, Anthropic, \$1,750.

Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

AI Policy Fellowship, Columbia AI Alignment Club.

Jan 2025 – June 2025

Service Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, \$1,500.

2022

Dean's List Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, \$500.

2022

MENTORING

Research Mentoring

- Peiyu Chen (2026), University of Chicago Booth School of Business.
- Maya De Ganyar (2026), UC Berkeley.
- Hannah Sun (2026), University of Washington.
- William Neild (2026), Emory.
- Alexander Kimpton (2026), Dragoman. Published. [9].
- Yusuf Kundgol (2026), Oxford. Published. [9].
- Daniel Graham (2026), State Street. Published. [9].
- Shruti Das (2026), Columbia University Masters. Former Apple.
- Weian Xie (2026), MIT.
- Saloni Modi (2026), Bloomberg. Former UT Austin. Published. [8].
- Hayzie Chu (2026), Brown University Undergrad.
- Niklas Weller (2026), University of St. Gallen PhD. Published. [7].
- Raghav Pant (2026), JPMorganChase. Former Brown University.
- Dan Sachs (2026), Independent Researcher. Former Georgetown University.
- Ciáran Walsh (2026), Columbia University Undergrad. Published. [6].
- Madhavendra Thakur (2025), Independent Researcher. Published. [1]. Now at Harvard; YC Fellow.
- Olivia Long (2025), Columbia University Undergrad. Published. [1, 3]. Former XLab.

ACADEMIC
SERVICE

Program Committee Member
• Workshops: AI for Social Impact (AAAI 2026, 2027)

Reviewer
• Conferences: NeurIPS (2025, 2026), IASEAI (2026)
• Workshops: SocialAgent (NeurIPS 2026), Interpretability as a Science (NeurIPS 2026), AI4GOOD (NeurIPS 2026), Pluralistic Alignment (ICML 2026), Models of Human Feedback for AI Alignment (ICML 2025), Socially Responsible Language Modeling Research (COLM 2025)

TECHNICAL
SKILLS

Languages & Tools:
Python, R, HTML, Git, L^AT_EX, Figma, Qualtrics, Amazon MTurk, Prolific Academic, OSF, arXiv

Human Languages:
English (native), Gilbertese (advanced), American Sign Language (basic)